

ZAIRA CHRISTA BARAKAT

London | zcbarakat@gmail.com

PROFILE

Oxford graduate and MA Cultural & Creative Industries candidate building culturally led, social-first work in fashion. Tripled ticket sales for Oxford's largest fashion event (150 to 450 over two editions) through a multi-platform social campaign, founded a fashion label, and researched how style, sound and identity spread through subcultures via fieldwork in Tokyo. Turns audience data into clear creative direction and uses AI tools to work faster without losing judgement.

EDUCATION

King's College London – *MA Cultural and Creative Industries* **2025 - 2026**
Dissertation: Tagging the Body: Sound, Clothing, and Affect in London Clubs
University of Oxford, Somerville College – *BA (Hons) Music, 2:1* **2022 - 2025**

EXPERIENCE

Zaira Christa Fashion Label **London | 2022 - Present**
Founder and Creative Director

- Founded an independent fashion label and brought two seasonal collections from initial concept through to runway presentation, directing all creative, production, and styling decisions independently.
- Built the label's brand and social presence across digital platforms, producing campaign imagery and editorial content that articulates a distinct creative point of view.

The Reach Brasserie **London | 2025 - 2026**
Bar Manager

- Ran daily operations of a high-footfall London venue, managing a seven-person team and suppliers while leading the venue's brand recovery: signage, menu design and content planning.
- Designed and launched a curated seasonal cocktail offering, balancing creative concept development with cost efficiency and commercial viability.

Oxford Fashion Gala **Oxford | 2023 - 2025**
Co-Creative Director & Co-Marketing Director

- Appointed to lead the end-to-end creative vision for Oxford's largest annual fashion event, directing concept development, casting, set design and choreography from brief to live performance.
- Grew ticket sales from 150 to 450 over two editions (+200%) with a multi-platform social campaign of curated content, strategic collaborations and a data-informed posting schedule.
- Delivered a cohesive campaign identity aligned with the Gala's creative vision, coordinating all audience-facing assets, copy, and promotional content across a team of volunteers.

Levi Strauss **London | 2025**
Stylist

- Exceeded Black Friday sales targets by delivering personalised styling consultations shaped around each customer's style and needs, raising units per transaction above the team benchmark.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Tokyo Drift - Cultural Ethnography **Tokyo | 2025**

- Three weeks of fieldwork in Tokyo's club scene (participant observation, interviews with DJs, designers and club owners) analysing how fashion and sound create subcultural identity; 10,000-word ethnography.

Bekaa - Hospitality Brand Strategy **Independent MA | 2025**

- Built a full brand strategy for a listening-bar concept, from cultural, competitor and market research through audience definition and positioning to content strategy and launch planning.

SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

Languages: English (fluent), French (advanced), Arabic - Lebanese dialect (intermediate), Spanish (beginner)
Transferable Skills: Trend and cultural analysis, audience research, creative direction, social content planning, AI-assisted research